Chapter 2: Nationalism in India & The Freedom Struggle (Board Exam U

Class 10 - Social Science | Unit: India and the Contemporary World - II (History)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Examines the mass mobilization of the Indian national movement led by Mahatma Gandhi, the Non-Cooperation Movement, Civil Disobedience, and the creation of collective national identity.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Analyze the socio-economic impact of the First World War and the Rowlatt Act 1919.
2. Trace the trajectory of the Non-Cooperation Movement and its suspension after Chauri Chaura in 1922.
3. Examine the Salt Satyagraha, Civil Disobedience Movement, and the role of women, peasants, and tribal communities.

1. SATYAGRAHA AND MASS MOBILIZATION

Satyagraha emphasized the power of truth and non-violence. Gandhi deployed it in Champaran (indigo farmers), Kheda (crop failure revenue relief), and Ahmedabad (cotton mill workers) before launching nationwide movements against the Rowlatt Act.

2. THE CIVIL DISOBEDIENCE MOVEMENT & SALT MARCH

In 1930, Gandhi marched 240 miles from Sabarmati to Dandi to manufacture salt from seawater, defying the oppressive British salt tax monopoly. The movement encouraged widespread boycott of foreign cloth, refusal of land revenue, and peaceful picketing.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students often confuse the Non-Cooperation Movement (refusal of cooperation without deliberate law violation) with the Civil Disobedience Movement (active defiance and breaking of colonial laws like the Salt Act).

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: What was the core distinction between the Non-Cooperation Movement and the Civil Disobedience Movement?

Expected Answer: In Non-Cooperation (1920-22), citizens refused to cooperate with colonial institutions; in Civil Disobedience (1930-34), citizens actively broke colonial laws like the Salt Law.

Q2: Why did Mahatma Gandhi choose Salt as the central symbol for nationwide agitation in 1930?

Expected Answer: Salt was an essential dietary commodity consumed equally by rich and poor; taxing salt and monopolizing its production exemplified British oppression affecting every household.